



tion and these AI assistants. You can stream content to the soundbar from your devices using Chromecast, Apple AirPlay 2 or Bluetooth. And then there is Dolby Atmos, which I will be talking about in the next section. I would love to see an app with the bar to make the experience a bit more complete for the end user. But that is something that I would leave for the execs at Philips to decide. Just saying, they have a great development team as we have seen with their Hue products. Different category, but there is scope.

Note: The Philips TAB8967 unit at the Test Centre had only the soundbar and the subwoofer. So, the opinions of the author are based on their experience with these two components. Your experience with the satellite speakers added in might vary.

Performance

Philips TAB8967 is a powerful package. This is what I would say if someone asked me to summarise my thoughts

about its performance. Be it watching movies, playing video games, or listening to music, the soundbar will serve you well. In movies, there was enough detail in the positioning of the sources and the same carried over in games as well. I am a fan of racing games and movies which have a lot of gunfire and action in them, so in either of these, what I would consider fairly challenging cases, the soundbar held its ground. There was enough details in my Top Gun: Maverick test, which I love doing across soundbars. And my

game of choice is Formula 1. Considering that the primary source of audio was in front of me, with Dolby Atmos trying to mimic additional speakers, the positioning of the audio, and the clarity from the real and virtual channels was something that I have rarely seen in soundbars that are in this price range.

If you are listening to music, I would say that you should try this out for yourself, depending on the genres you love. Fans of pop, Bollywood, and hip-hop music, look no further. The bass is there to rock the inner music aficionado from you. If you are a fan of heavy metal music or are someone who listens to a lot of podcasts, then the lack of clarity in the mids due to the bass boost out of the box might be off-putting for you. You can tune the audio to your liking, but out of the box, the sound is a bit too heavy on the bass. Now, when watching movies, this is somewhat apparent in the dialogue-heavy sections too. But, the way the audio is mastered in movies, there is not much of a detail loss that you would notice.

Final thoughts

The Philips TAB8967 is the only soundbar from the brand that is available in India. And, if I were managing the business at Philips, I would be happy with what the brand has brought into the Indian market. The nature of the content that is majorly consumed in India, suits the sound signature of this soundbar. The bass from the subwoofer is something that would be a major factor which draws people towards this bar. Couple that with great build, a limited, yet solid selection of features, and you have a great product. If Philips can iron out whatever creases there are, add an app, the Philips TAB8967 would be a blind recommendation. For now, it still is a winner, but there are others within striking distance, and based on who the referee is, they might crown some competition from JBL, Sony, and Samsung as their winners too! **d**

ACCESSORIES

- Power cord
- Remote Control
- 2 x AAA Batteries
- Wall mount bracket
- Quick start guide
- Warranty Card